

B.A. in Music: where to start

For prospective first-year, transfer, and second-bachelor's students · fall 2027 entry



B.A. in Music page

Degree	Length	Applied areas	Contact
Bachelor of Arts in Music	120 units, four years (two for transfer)	Instrument, voice, composition, music production	Music office, (510) 885-3135

01 The program

The Bachelor of Arts in Music is 120 units: 54 in music, 48 in general education and graduation requirements, and 18 in free electives. You take applied lessons and ensembles from your first semester in lessons to your last, alongside music theory, aural skills, keyboard musicianship, music history, and music technology. Music electives cover music education, conducting, composition and music production, global music, entrepreneurship, and performance.

Students perform and record, compose and arrange, score for film and games, produce and design sound in the studios, conduct, teach music in California schools, and go on to graduate study. The Department is an accredited institutional member of the National Association of Schools of Music.



Roadmaps and undergraduate handbook

02 Ways in

First-year students follow the four-year roadmap. Transfer students with the Associate Degree for Transfer in Music enter at junior standing and complete 60 units in residence over two years. If you already hold a bachelor's in another field, you can apply for the B.A. as a second bachelor's: general education is already complete, and you take the music portion of the degree. Students with informal musicianship backgrounds are assessed in musicianship and theory and placed accordingly.

03 How to apply

1. Apply to Cal State East Bay through Cal State Apply, choosing the B.A. in Music. The Department sets no admission requirements beyond the University's.
2. Ask every school you've attended (high school, community college, or another college or university) to send official transcripts to the Office of Admissions, electronically to electronictranscripts@csueastbay.edu. Track what's outstanding in MyCSUEB.
3. Sign up for an applied area placement: an audition in your instrument or voice, or a creative portfolio in composition or music production. In-person auditions are preferred, and you can also submit materials online. The placement is required to begin lessons, and placements completed by the scholarship deadline are considered for music scholarships.
4. Check the application and document deadlines for the term you're applying to.



Cal State Apply



Auditions and placements



Transcripts and documents



Undergraduate deadlines

04 Paying for the degree

The Department awards music scholarships to incoming music majors every year. There is no separate scholarship application: your audition or portfolio is the scholarship audition when it's completed by the scholarship deadline. Continuing students are considered each year for their work in the Department. The University's Pioneer Scholarships are open to all students, and the Office of Financial Aid handles federal and state aid.



Music scholarships

05 Ensembles and studios

The major performing ensembles are the East Bay Singers, the East Bay Jazz Orchestra, and the East Bay Wind Symphony. For string players, Chamber Orchestra is the major performing ensemble. The chamber ensembles are Rock Band, Chamber Ensemble, Percussion Ensemble, Chamber Orchestra, Electronic Music Ensemble, Piano Ensemble, Jazz Combo, Vocal Repertory Ensemble, the East Bay Jazz Singers, Chamber Singers, and A Cappella Ensemble. Placement happens at the first meeting of each ensemble, and non-majors can join too.



Ensembles

The Computer Music Lab has 20 workstations running Ableton Live, Logic Pro, and VCV Rack. The Synthesis and Recording Studio adds Max/MSP, a modular synthesis station built around the Department's restored Buchla 100, and a Pro Tools station with a dedicated recording room.

06 Certificate in Music Education

You can add the Certificate in Music Education to the B.A. The certificate covers the subject matter coursework for the California Single Subject Teaching Credential in Music, and several of its courses also count as B.A. music electives. The credential itself is a separate program. John Eros coordinates music education (john.eros@csueastbay.edu).



Music education

07 B.A. and M.A. together

Once you're in the B.A., you can apply to FAST in the junior year and finish both degrees in five years (FAST 4+1), or in three if you entered as a transfer student (FAST 2+1), with up to 11 graduate units counting toward both. Second-bachelor's students and double majors aren't eligible for FAST.



FAST 4+1

08 Visit and contacts

Hear a rehearsal, see the recital hall and the studios, and meet the faculty and students. Call or write the music office to arrange a visit.

Office	Contact
Music office	MB 2569 · (510) 885-3135 · music@csueastbay.edu
Music education	John Eros · john.eros@csueastbay.edu
FAST 4+1	Inés Thiebaut, Graduate Coordinator · (510) 885-3126 · ines.thiebaut@csueastbay.edu

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